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Cabot ALPR Audit Evaluation

Prepared: August 12, 2026

Scope: Review of Cabot Police Department Policy 305.1, the January-June 2024 and January-June 2025 public reports, the 2025 supporting workbook, and the June 5-July 4, 2026 public search-audit CSV. This is a review of the supplied records on their face, not a finding about any individual search or legal compliance.

Executive conclusion

Cabot’s written policy closely tracks the principal Arkansas statutory requirements, and Cabot has produced public reports and a native statistical workbook. Those are meaningful transparency practices. The records also contain material reconciliation problems that prevent the public from reproducing the January-June 2025 report.

The most important findings are:

1. The July 9, 2025 memorandum reports **7,023,170 scans, 279 positive alerts, 3 non-correlating matches, and 12 matches resulting in arrest and prosecution.**
2. The supporting workbook’s monthly scan totals sum to **7,555,734**, exceeding the memorandum by **532,564 scans**. The workbook does not identify an exclusion or adjustment that reconciles the difference.
3. The workbook’s positive-alert monthly totals sum to **279**, exactly matching the memorandum.
4. The workbook’s rows labeled Matches that Did Not Correlate to the Alert sum to **617**, while the memorandum reports **3**. Because the wording describes the same reporting category, the difference requires an agency explanation or corrected source file.
5. The 2024 report identified 763 non-correlating matches—762 attributed to mobile Axon LPR and one Flock state-read error. The 2025 memorandum says Cabot was no longer integrated with Axon because its numbers were inaccurate and it produced almost all false hits. This may explain the change between years, but it does not reconcile the 617-versus-3 conflict within the 2025 records.
6. The 2026 public search-audit CSV contains **469 searches**. The user field is masked in every row, 157 reasons are blank, 45 contain Traffic, and 360 searches span more than 1,000 networks. The redaction prevents public per-user auditing.
7. Policy 305.1 has a strong statutory core but contains no recurring audit schedule, no required contemporaneous query reason or case number, and no lifecycle rule for manually entered hotlist plates.

Documents evaluated

Record	Date / period	Role
Cabot Policy 305.1	Implemented September 13, 2022	Written ALPR requirements
LPR Chief Letter	January-June 2024; dated July 15, 2024	Six-month public report
Flock report	January-June 2025; dated July 9, 2025	Six-month public report
Flock Data workbook	January-June 2025	Daily scans and alert-category support
Public search-audit CSV	June 5-July 4, 2026 UTC	Historical-search audit fields

Duplicate copies were not counted as additional evidence.

Six-month report comparison

Metric	Jan.-June 2024 report	Jan.-June 2025 report	2025 workbook
Plates scanned	7,365,404	7,023,170	7,555,734 monthly total
Positive alerts / matches	1,022	279	279 monthly total
Did not correlate / false hit	763	3	617 monthly total
Resulted in arrest and prosecution	13	12	Not identified in workbook

The reports use the statutory phrase arrest and prosecution. They do not identify the cases, define whether prosecution means referral or formally filed charges, or provide final dispositions. The figures therefore should not be described as convictions.

2025 scan reconciliation

Month	Workbook scan total
January	1,040,530
February	1,083,229
March	1,431,298
April	1,350,664
May	1,373,416
June	1,276,597
Workbook total	7,555,734
Memorandum total	7,023,170
Unreconciled difference	532,564

The workbook includes fixed-camera, Flex, and mobile-LPR columns. A difference in source-system scope, revised data, downtime treatment, or exclusion rules could explain the mismatch, but no such rule is documented in the supplied records.

2025 alert reconciliation

Month	Positive-alert total	Did-not-correlate total
January	55	102
February	16	87

Month	Positive-alert total	Did-not-correlate total
March	38	129
April	25	120
May	55	77
June	90	102
Workbook total	279	617
Memorandum total	279	3

The positive-alert total reconciles exactly. The non-correlation total does not. The workbook expressly labels these entries Matches that Did Not Correlate to the Alert, the same category required by Policy 305.1 and used in the memorandum. The public record needs either a corrected workbook, corrected memorandum, or a data dictionary explaining why 617 underlying entries become three reportable false hits.

Scale ratios

These ratios are descriptive and do not measure legality or program value:

- The 2025 memorandum's 279 positive alerts equal approximately **0.00397%** of 7,023,170 scans.
- Twelve reported arrest-and-prosecution matches equal approximately **one per 585,264 scans** and **one per 23.25 positive alerts**.
- If the workbook's 7,555,734 scan total is the correct denominator, the corresponding scan ratio changes. The report should not be used for efficiency claims until the scan population is reconciled.

Public search-audit CSV

Metric	Observed value
Rows / distinct IDs	469 / 469
Displayed period	June 5-July 4, 2026 UTC
User identifiers	Masked as *** in all rows
Blank reasons	157 (33.48%)
Reasons containing Traffic	45 (9.59%)
Median networks searched	5,982
Maximum networks searched	6,279
More than one network	462 (98.51%)
More than 1,000 networks	360 (76.76%)
More than 5,000 networks	322 (68.66%)

The reason field ranges from case-like entries to terms such as ICP, Investigation, Traffic, patrol, and blanks. A blank field does not prove that no lawful purpose existed, but it prevents the CSV alone from demonstrating the purpose.

Masking every user protects personnel information but removes an important accountability dimension. A public audit can use stable pseudonyms—such as User 001—without publishing names. That would permit review of training, volume, repeated blank reasons, unusual scope, and supervisory sampling while limiting unnecessary identification.

The network-count field documents the breadth of each query's configured search scope. It does not show how many agencies returned a result or whether any outside image was viewed, downloaded, or used.

Policy assessment

Policy 305.1 includes:

- trained and individually authorized users;
- visual and ACIC/NCIC confirmation before an alert-based enforcement contact;
- documentation of confirmed hits and resulting investigations or prosecutions;
- the 150-day ordinary retention ceiling;
- the two statutory destruction endpoints for data retained with an ongoing investigation;
- 24-hour updates when available;
- the evidence-of-an-offense threshold for interagency sharing;
- six-month public reports preserved for eighteen months;
- privacy restrictions; and
- public inspection of the policy.

The principal governance gaps are:

1. No recurring audit of searches, downloads, stops, sharing, retention, or hotlists is required.
2. Historical searches do not expressly require a reason, case/CAD number, scope justification, or supervisor-approved exception.
3. Manually added hotlist entries have no stated supporting-facts requirement, review interval, expiration, or removal rule.
4. The policy's broad other activities clause depends on approval but does not establish written criteria.
5. The policy does not establish a reporting data dictionary, reconciliation procedure, revision history, or certification control.

What the records do and do not establish

Established

- Cabot publishes six-month statistical memoranda.
- A native 2025 workbook provides daily and monthly supporting data.
- The workbook corroborates the 279 positive-alert total.
- The scan and non-correlation figures do not reconcile with the 2025 memorandum.
- A 2026 public audit CSV documents hundreds of searches and broad network scopes.

Not established

- Which 12 cases were counted as both arrest and prosecution.
- Whether the 2025 memorandum or workbook contains the correct scan and non-correlation totals.
- Whether blank audit reasons lacked supporting records elsewhere.
- Whether a broad network search returned or exposed outside-agency data.
- Whether any individual search was proper or improper.

Focused follow-up records

1. The native dataset and calculation worksheet used to produce the 7,023,170 scan total.
2. A written reconciliation of 7,555,734 workbook scans versus 7,023,170 reported scans.
3. A written reconciliation of 617 workbook non-correlations versus three reported false hits.
4. Definitions for positive alert, confirmed match, did not correlate, false hit, and arrest and prosecution.
5. De-identified case-level support for the 12 reported arrest-and-prosecution matches.
6. A complete 2026 audit export with stable pseudonymous users, case/CAD fields, result sources, views, downloads, and dispositions.
7. Written procedures for blank reasons, broad network searches, manual hotlist entry, expiration, and supervisory review.
8. Any biennial review record or revision of Policy 305.1.

Bottom line

Cabot's reporting structure is stronger than a program that publishes no statistics or supporting data. The supporting workbook, however, reveals two material inconsistencies that should be resolved before the January-June 2025 figures are used to claim effectiveness, accuracy, or statutory completeness. A corrected report, calculation dictionary, and recurring documented search audit would substantially improve reliability.

Authority and source integrity

- Arkansas Act 668 of 2025, amending Arkansas Code §§ 12-12-1803 through 12-12-1805.
- Cabot Police Department, Policy 305.1, implemented September 13, 2022.
- 2024 LPR Chief Letter January to June.pdf.
- Flock report Jan-June 2025.pdf.
- Flock Data Jan-June 2025.xlsx.
- public_search_audit 7-6-2026 Cabot.csv.

Selected source-file SHA-256 values are maintained in the accompanying evidence manifest.

This report is a records and governance analysis, not legal advice or a finding of misconduct.